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Toh 652 · Derge Kangyur

Toh 652 in the Kangyur is a short dhāraṇī text known in Tibetan as the dhāraṇī associated with the bodhisattva Gyalwé Lama, whose name corresponds to the Sanskrit Jayottaraguru, meaning something like "Teacher of Supreme Victory." The text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist canonical literature, a class of works centered on the transmission of sacred mantra formulas believed to confer spiritual and protective benefits on those who hold or recite them. In this case, the bodhisattva Gyalwé Lama addresses the Buddha directly, promising that whoever retains this particular ground-dhāraṇī will thereby encompass all phenomena, be freed from the eight unfree states that obstruct spiritual practice, and receive the protection of a yakṣa guardian against illness and fear in every lifetime. The text concludes with the dhāraṇī mantra itself, presented in transliterated Sanskrit syllables. It is classified among the dhāraṇī collections of the Kangyur, the section of the Tibetan Buddhist canon containing texts regarded as Buddha-word.

The dhāraṇī that holds the Victor is complete.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Gyalwé Lama addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, whoever holds this ground-dhāraṇī mantra of Gyalwé Lama will thereby come to hold all phenomena together with it. They will pass beyond the eight unfree states. In every lifetime, that yakṣa will guard, protect, and shelter them, and they will have no fear from any illness."

Syādy athaṃ. Buddhe buddhe. Jayottara. Bodhanī bodhanī. Saṃbodhanī. Mahāsaṃbodhanī. Adhisambodhanī. Hala hala hala. Hili hili hili. Hulu hulu hulu. Sarva buddha. Dharmāva bodhinī. Sphuṭa sphuṭa sphuṭa. Sarva pāpāni.

Translator's Notes

- The name "Gyalwé Lama" is a Tibetan epithet meaning "Guru of the Victors" or "Preceptor of the Jinas." It is not further identified in this passage fragment; it appears to be the name of a specific bodhisattva associated with this dhāraṇī text, though the broader context of the text is needed to identify which figure is intended with certainty.

The "eight unfree states" refers to the eight conditions of spiritual non-leisure, the aṣṭākṣaṇāḥ in Sanskrit, in which a being lacks the freedom to practice the Dharma.

The mantra syllables are rendered in reconstructed Sanskrit transliteration rather than translated, as is standard for dhāraṇī and mantra passages. The Tibetan phonetic rendering has been normalized to standard Sanskrit orthography where possible.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.